of a better understanding of how Bolshevism functioned. Rather than viewing the new Russian government by the same parameters of the tsarist regime, Chelmsford and Hamilton Grant, for example, appeared to grasp the idea that the Bolshevik ideology was most successful when popular discontent supplied it with fertile breeding ground. Hence the warnings not to upset the Persians or the Afghans by forcing unpopular diplomatic agreements on them. Perhaps the simple answer as to why the Indian government did not hold the same Great Game mentality as Curzon is that the day-to-day exposure which its officials had with South Asians made it more attune to the changes which had overcome the region since the First World War. Russia was the threat of yesterday, even if it did have a new ideological form. The problem of today was how to manage the pan-Islamic and nationalist fervour taking hold of Persia, Afghanistan and India.

The difficulty for the Indian government was that Curzon was not the type of man to listen to others. And herein lay the crux of the matter. That Curzon followed a Great Game mentality was not itself a unique fallacy. Indeed, there were others within the British government who shared aspects of his world view. Cox and Mallet had, of course, encouraged the creation of the 1919 Persian agreement; Hardinge and Eyre Crowe had also on occasion questioned the Indian government's apparent interference in what they deemed to be Foreign Office affairs; and Winston Churchill was perhaps an even greater Russophobe than the foreign secretary himself. That the Indian government might disagree with the Home government over issues of foreign affairs was also not an unusual occurrence. Minto had objected to the creation of the 1907 Anglo-Russian convention, while Curzon had had his own battle with London over Kitchener's reforms to India's military. Instead, Curzon's cardinal sin was to not recognise that in some circumstances it might be worth listening to others, even if what they were saying was not what he wanted to hear. By refusing point blank to pay the slightest attention to Delhi, to concede in even the smallest way that the viceroy's contributions to the formulation of foreign policy was valid, it meant that the foreign secretary was ignoring valuable expert opinion.

The trouble was that Curzon's travels, writings and time as viceroy had not only given him a Great Game mentality, but had also provided him with an unwarranted confidence in his own knowledge of South Asia. Despite the